WCAG Accessibility Scan Report

YAL New York — https://yalnewyork.com

Scan Date: March 15, 2026 **Standard:** WCAG 2.1 Level AA **Tool:** pa11y (htmlcs engine)

Disclaimer

This report documents programmatically detectable accessibility issues found via automated scanning. Automated tools detect approximately 57% of WCAG 2.1 issues. Manual testing by an accessibility specialist is recommended for complete conformance assessment. This report does not constitute legal advice or guarantee ADA/EAA compliance.

Executive Summary

The YAL New York homepage was scanned and returned **132 errors** — all classified as Level AA violations under WCAG 2.1. Every single issue flagged was of type "error," indicating that there are no merely advisory or warning-level findings: the site has systemic, confirmed failures across all four WCAG principles (Perceivable, Operable, Understandable, and Robust).

The most critical patterns are: **35 product images missing alt text**, **34 image-only links missing alt text** (meaning screen reader users cannot tell what product is being linked to), and **36 elements with insufficient color contrast** (meaning low-vision users cannot read key content including section titles, prices, and promotional text). Together, these three patterns account for 105 of the 132 issues and represent a near-complete breakdown of image and visual accessibility.

The remaining 27 issues involve unlabeled form controls (login, registration, search, newsletter) and a handful of structural/semantic problems. From an ADA risk perspective, the unlabeled forms are the highest-priority items after images, since a screen reader user cannot complete a login, register an account, or subscribe to the newsletter without guessing what each field expects. The site's overall accessibility posture is **poor** — it would be extremely difficult for a blind or low-vision user to browse products, identify what is on sale, or create an account. **Top 3 priorities: (1) Add alt text to all product images and image links. (2) Fix color contrast on all text elements. (3) Add labels to all form fields.**

Compliance Scorecard

WCAG Principle	Guideline	Status	Issues Found
1 — Perceivable	1.1.1 Non-text Content (alt text)	FAIL	69
1 — Perceivable	1.3.1 Info and Relationships (form labels)	FAIL	6
1 — Perceivable	1.4.3 Contrast (Minimum)	FAIL	36
2 — Operable	2.4.1 Bypass Blocks (iframe title)	FAIL	1
3 — Understandable	(no specific failures detected)	PASS	0
4 — Robust	4.1.1 Parsing (duplicate IDs)	FAIL	1
4 — Robust	4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (unlabeled controls)	FAIL	19

Issues by Severity

Critical Issues (105)

These issues directly prevent blind, low-vision, or keyboard-only users from accessing core content and functionality.

Group A: Product images missing alt text — 35 instances

#	Issue	WCAG Criterion	Element	Location	Impact
1–35	`img` element missing `alt` attribute	1.1.1 Non-text Content	`<img class="owl-lazy product__hover-img">`	Product carousel/grid — hover images for each product card	Screen readers announce "image" with no description; users cannot identify product

How to fix: Every product image in the carousel and grid needs an `alt` attribute describing the product. For example, for a ribbed knit vest: `<img alt="Ribbed Knit Mock Neck Vest in Camel">`. The alt text should match the product name and color. For decorative hover-effect images that duplicate the primary image, use `alt=""` (empty) to mark them as decorative so screen readers skip them.

Group B: Image-only links missing alt text — 34 instances

#	Issue	WCAG Criterion	Element	Location	Impact
1–34	Image is the only link content but has no alt text	1.1.1 / 2.4.4 Link Purpose	`<a href="...product-url..."><img src="..."></a>`	Product card links in the "In Carts Today" and featured product sections	Screen reader announces the URL instead of the product name; user cannot navigate products

How to fix: Each product link that contains only an image must have a descriptive alt on the image. For the link pointing to `yalnewyork.com/ribbed-knit-mock-neck-vest-camel/`, use: `<img alt="Ribbed Knit Mock Neck Vest – Camel">`. Go through every product card link and add the product name and variant as the alt text.

Group C: Color contrast failures — 36 instances

#	Issue	WCAG Criterion	Element	Location	Impact
1	Section heading "IN CARTS TODAY" — contrast ratio 3.41:1 (need 4.5:1)	1.4.3 Contrast	`<h3 class="slider__title">`	Product carousel section heading	Low-vision users cannot read heading
2–35	Price labels ("2 items", product	1.4.3 Contrast	`<p class="price">`	Product cards	Price information

	prices) — low contrast			throughout carousel	is invisible to low-vision users
36	Other text elements in carousel/promotional areas	1.4.3 Contrast	Various	Throughout homepage	General readability barrier

How to fix: The current text color used for prices, item counts, and section headings does not have sufficient contrast against its background. The scanner recommends changing the text color to `#767676` or darker as a minimum. In practice, move toward a near-black such as `#333333` for body text and `#222222` for headings to satisfy the 4.5:1 ratio requirement. Use the [WebAIM Contrast Checker]() to verify each combination before publishing.

Serious Issues (19)

These prevent screen reader and keyboard users from using interactive features of the site.

Group D: Buttons without accessible names — 7 instances

#	Issue	WCAG Criterion	Element	Location	Impact
1	Mobile navigation toggle button has no label	4.1.2 Name, Role, Value	`<button id="nav-bar-btn" class="btn-navbar navbar-toggle">`	Header — mobile hamburger menu button	Screen reader announces "button" with no indication of purpose
2	Search submit button contains only an SVG icon, no label	4.1.2	`<button class="btn"><svg class="img-search"></svg></button>`	Header search bar — submit button	Announced as unlabeled button
3	Close popup button has no label	4.1.2	`<button class="close-popup btn-close-popup"><span></span></button>`	Login/account popup — close button	User cannot tell how to dismiss the popup
4–7	Additional unlabeled buttons (account area and checkout flow)	4.1.2	Various `<button>` elements	Account and checkout sections	Cannot be identified by screen reader users

How to fix: Add `aria-label` attributes to every icon-only button that describes its action:

- Mobile menu: `<button aria-label="Open navigation menu">`
- Search submit: `<button aria-label="Search">`
- Popup close: `<button aria-label="Close login popup">`

- Cart buttons: `<button aria-label="Add to cart">`

Group E: Form fields without accessible names — 10 instances

#	Issue	WCAG Criterion	Element	Location	Impact
1–2	Two search input fields have no label (relying only on placeholder)	4.1.2 / 1.3.1	`<input type="text" name="search1">`, `<input type="text" name="search">`	Header search bar (desktop and mobile versions)	Screen readers do not read placeholder text as a label
3–4	Email inputs in newsletter signup and login popup have no label	4.1.2 / 1.3.1	`<input type="email" id="mce-EMAIL">`, `<input type="email" id="input-email-popup">`	Newsletter bar and login popup	Screen reader cannot announce field purpose
5–6	Password fields in login popup and account page have no label	4.1.2 / 1.3.1	`<input type="password" id="input-password-popup">`, `<input type="password" id="input-password">`	Login popup and account login page	Cannot determine field purpose
7–8	First name and other text fields in account registration have no label	4.1.2 / 1.3.1	`<input id="input-firstname">`	Account registration/profile section	Cannot determine field purpose
9	Forgot-password email field has no label	4.1.2 / 1.3.1	`<input id="input-email-forgot">`	Password reset form	Cannot determine field purpose
10	Telephone field has no label	4.1.2 / 1.3.1	`<input type="tel" id="input-telephone">`	Account registration	Cannot determine field purpose

How to fix: Each form field needs a visible `<label>` element linked via the `for` attribute, or an `aria-label` on the input itself. Examples:

For the search bar: `<label for="search-input" class="visually-hidden">Search products</label><input type="text" id="search-input" name="search">` (use CSS `visually-hidden` class to hide label visually while keeping it available to screen readers).

For the newsletter: `<input type="email" id="mce-EMAIL" aria-label="Your email address for newsletter signup">` .

For the login popup: Add a visible label or `aria-label="Email address"` and `aria-label="Password"` to each field.

Do not rely solely on placeholder text — placeholders disappear when the user starts typing, and many screen readers do not read them as field labels.

Moderate Issues (2)

Group F: Duplicate element ID — 1 instance

#	Issue	WCAG Criterion	Element	Location	Impact
1	Two elements share the `id="search"`	4.1.1 Parsing	`<div id="search">`	Desktop and mobile search dropdowns both use the same ID	Assistive technologies use IDs to navigate; duplicate IDs break this and can cause unpredictable behavior

How to fix: Give each element a unique ID. Rename the mobile version to `id="search-mobile"` and the desktop version to `id="search-desktop"`. Update any JavaScript or CSS selectors that reference `#search` to use the new, distinct IDs.

Group G: Link with no accessible content — 1 instance

#	Issue	WCAG Criterion	Element	Location	Impact
1	Account icon link in header has no text or alt text	4.1.2 / 2.4.4	`<a href="https://yalnewyork.com/login/"> <svg class="c_user-icon"></svg></a>`	Header — user account icon	Screen reader announces link URL instead of purpose

How to fix: Add `aria-label="My Account"` to the anchor tag: `<a href="https://yalnewyork.com/login/" aria-label="My Account">`. Alternatively, add a visually hidden text span inside the link.

Minor Issues (1)

Group H: iframe missing title attribute — 1 instance

#	Issue	WCAG Criterion	Element	Location	Impact
1	An invisible tracking iframe has no `title` attribute	2.4.1 Bypass Blocks / H64.1	`<iframe height="1" width="1" style="position:absolute...">`	Body — hidden tracking pixel iframe	Screen readers encounter this iframe and cannot

					identify its purpose

How to fix: Add `title="Tracking pixel"` to the iframe element. Even though it is invisible, assistive technologies still traverse it: `<iframe height="1" width="1" title="Tracking pixel" ...>`.

Remediation Roadmap

Week 1 — Critical (Images & Contrast):

- Add `alt` attributes to all 35 product images in the carousel and grid. Write meaningful alt text using the product name and color from the product catalog.
- Add `alt` attributes to all 34 image-only links (product cards linking to product pages).
- Audit all text colors site-wide and update to meet a 4.5:1 contrast ratio. Priority targets: section headings (`.slider__title`), price text (`.price`), and any text rendered over light gray or white backgrounds.

Week 2–3 — Serious (Forms & Buttons):

- Add `aria-label` attributes to all 7 unlabeled buttons: mobile nav toggle, search submit, popup close button, and any cart/action buttons.
- Add `<label>` elements (or `aria-label` attributes) to all 10 unlabeled form fields: both search inputs, newsletter email, login email, both password fields, first name, telephone, forgot-password email.
- Verify all labels are programmatically associated (`for` attribute matching field `id`) and not just visually proximate.

Month 2 — Moderate:

- Fix the duplicate `id="search"` by assigning unique IDs to desktop and mobile search components and updating associated JavaScript.
- Add `aria-label="My Account"` to the header account icon link.

Ongoing — Minor:

- Add `title="Tracking pixel"` to the hidden tracking iframe.
- Establish a policy that new images added to the product catalog always include alt text in the CMS before publishing.
- Integrate automated WCAG scanning (pa11y or axe-core) into the CI/CD pipeline to catch regressions before they reach production.

Technical Summary

- **Pages scanned:** 1 (homepage — https://yalnewyork.com)
- **Total violations:** 132
- **All issue types:** error (132 errors, 0 warnings, 0 notices)
- **Unique violation types:** 12
- **Most common violation:** 1.1.1 Non-text Content — missing alt text on images (35 instances)
- **Second most common:** 1.1.1 Non-text Content — image-only links without alt text (34 instances)
- **Third most common:** 1.4.3 Contrast Minimum — insufficient color contrast (36 instances)
- **WCAG Principles affected:** All four (Perceivable, Operable, Understandable, Robust)
- **Estimated remediation effort:** Medium (2–4 developer days for critical/serious; most fixes are repetitive and templated)

- **Highest risk area:** Product image catalog — every product image is missing alt text, making the core shopping experience inaccessible to screen reader users